

SkyPath — Information Architecture

Airline Booking Platform • Information Architecture Specification

This document defines the structural model used to organize SkyPath's content, navigation and booking tasks. It connects user research and personas to the subsequent sitemap, user flows and interface design.

1. Purpose

The Information Architecture (IA) organizes SkyPath around traveller goals and task progression. The structure separates discovery and booking from post-booking management while keeping support accessible throughout the experience.

2. IA Objectives

- Make flight discovery and search easy to initiate.
- Support meaningful comparison before selection.
- Reveal complexity progressively as the booking task advances.
- Keep passenger, seat and add-on information logically grouped.
- Make the final price and booking contents easy to verify.
- Provide a clear transition from booking confirmation to trip management.
- Maintain predictable access to check-in and support.
- Support accessible, understandable navigation across the product.

3. Top-Level Architecture

Primary area	Purpose	Key content
Home	Discovery and entry point	Flight search, recent searches, popular routes
Flights	Search and select flights	Search, results, filters, comparison, flight details, fares
My Trips	Manage existing bookings	Upcoming trips, itinerary, changes, cancellation
Check-in	Complete pre-flight check-in	Booking retrieval, passenger verification, check-in
Help	Resolve questions and problems	Help centre, FAQs, policies, refunds, accessibility, support

4. Core Booking Architecture

The booking journey follows a progressive sequence in which each stage resolves a specific user decision:

Search Flights → Search Results → Compare → Flight Details → Fare Selection → Passenger Information → Seats & Add-ons → Booking Review → Payment → Confirmation

5. Search and Discovery

The search experience prioritizes the minimum information needed to identify relevant flights. Secondary discovery content such as recent searches and popular routes supports exploration without competing with the primary search task.

6. Flight Selection

Search results, filters, sorting, comparison, flight details and fare options form a connected decision-making cluster. The architecture keeps important trade-offs visible before the user commits to a flight or fare.

7. Passenger and Personalization Architecture

Passenger information is separated from flight selection because it marks a transition from exploration to transaction. Seat selection, baggage, meals, special assistance and optional services are grouped as personalization tasks.

8. Review, Payment and Confirmation

The review stage acts as an error-prevention checkpoint. It consolidates the itinerary, passengers, selected services, fare and total price before payment. Confirmation then provides the booking reference, itinerary and direct access to post-booking actions.

9. Post-Booking Architecture

After purchase, the user's goal changes from selecting a journey to managing an existing journey. My Trips therefore contains booking details, itinerary access, changes and cancellation, while Check-in provides a direct task entry point.

10. Support Architecture

Help is treated as a cross-product service. Users may need support during search, fare selection, passenger entry, payment or post-booking management. The architecture therefore combines a global Help destination with contextual support links at high-risk decision points.

11. Detailed Sitemap Structure

■ SkyPath

■ Home

■ Flights

■ Search

■ Search Results

■ Filters & Sort

■ Compare Flights

■ Flight Details

■ Fare Options

■ My Trips

■ Upcoming Trips

■ Booking Details

■ Itinerary

■ Change Flight

■ Cancellation

■ Check-in

■ Find Booking

■ Passenger Verification

■ Check-in Confirmation

■ Help

■ Help Centre

■ FAQs

■ Travel Policies

■ Refund Information

■ Accessibility Assistance

■ Contact Support

12. Navigation Principles

Principle	Application
Task-oriented	Organize navigation around traveller goals rather than internal business structure.
Predictable	Use labels that accurately communicate what users will find.
Progressive	Introduce complexity when it becomes relevant.
Persistent	Keep core destinations and support discoverable.
Recoverable	Allow users to edit choices and recover from errors.
Accessible	Avoid relying solely on colour, visual position or precise pointer interaction.

13. Traceability

The IA is intentionally traceable to the preceding research work and the following design activities:

User Research → Personas → Card Sorting → Content Inventory → Navigation Model → Sitemap → Information Architecture → User Flows → Wireframes → High-Fidelity Design

14. Design Rationale

The architecture prioritizes the traveller's decision sequence: discover, search, compare, select, provide information, personalize, verify, pay and manage. This reduces the need to understand the product's internal organization and instead exposes the structure at the moment it becomes useful.

15. Limitations

The IA represents a design model derived from the project's research synthesis and content requirements. It should be validated through additional card-sorting sessions, tree testing and usability testing before production implementation. Airline-specific policies and operational constraints may also change the availability or ordering of certain post-booking functions.

16. Next Design Stage

The sitemap and navigation model provide the structural foundation for user flows and wireframes. The next stage should translate the architecture into task-level interaction flows and progressively more detailed interface representations.